

1. Research UX Roles

- Look up what it means to be a **generalist**, **specialist**, and **T-shaped designer**.
- Generalist=A knowledge about a lot of areas of expertise
- Specialist=A specialist possesses deep knowledge and can solve highly complex problems and deliver advanced solutions, but only within their area of expertise
- T-shaped=combines the vertical bar of deep expertise in one specific area with the horizontal bar of broad working knowledge across a lot of expertise
- Explore the advantages and disadvantages of each.
- Generalist, Advantages=Adapts easily to shifting project needs, Sees the big picture of a product or business, Communicates well with different teams because they understand multiple disciplines, Fits well in small teams or startups with limited staff.
Disadvantages=Lacks the deep mastery needed for complex, highly technical problems, May produce work that is good, but not top-tier, in specific fields like animation or advanced data research,Faces heavy competition for specialized roles.
- Specialist, Advantages=Solves complex, high-level problems within their niche, Produces exceptionally high-quality and fast work in their core area, Commands higher pay or demand for rare, niche skills, Becomes the go-to expert when teams face hard roadblocks.
Disadvantages=Struggles to see how other parts of a project affect their work, Depends heavily on other team members to fill in the gaps, Faces career risks if their specific tool or niche becomes outdated, Harder to place in small companies that need one person to do many jobs.
- T-shaped, Advantages=Combines the problem-solving depth of a specialist with the team flexibility of a generalist, Collaborates smoothly with engineers, marketers, and other specialists, Leads cross-functional teams effectively because they speak everyone's language, Stays adaptable if industry trends change.
Disadvantages=Takes time and effort to build both broad and deep skills, Risk of spreading attention too thin and losing deep focus, Hard to hire for because true T-shaped skill sets are rare.

2. Research Work Environments

- Investigate what a UX designer's role might look like in these settings:

- Freelancer

Working for themselves and market for yourself to find customers

- Intern

A short term job with limited responsibility, but can be lead to a full time job

- Entry-level position

Roles that do not require prior experience in the field

- Small startup

You shape the entire product from scratch with a tiny team

- Large company

You focus on a tiny piece of a massive product ecosystem

- For each, describe the kinds of tasks or responsibilities a UX designer may need to take on.

3. Compare & Reflect

- Write a 1–2 page report (or equivalent slides/presentation if preferred) that:
 - Defines the terms (generalist, specialist, T-shaped).
 - Summarizes how a UX designer’s role changes depending on the work environment.
 - Reflects on which role(s) or environment(s) you personally think would suit you best, and why.

If you are a generalist you work on a broad range of skills across multiple domains. If you are a specialist you are an expert who dives deep into a single, specific niche of design. If you work as a T-shaped designer you combine the vertical bar of deep expertise in one specific area with the horizontal bar of broad working knowledge across a wide range of expertise. UX designers roles change depending on the work environment in many ways. You could be more or less useful depending on whether or not your team needs your specific job that much or if someone else has the same job as you. If you are the only one with your specific skill set working on that specific job, you may need to work a lot more then if you had 2 or 3 other people working with that one

set of skills. If your team has no clue what to do and you have the skills to do it and make their project better, you are more likely to be wanted back on that team because you have something they cannot do. I think I would be a specialist because when I pick one thing to work on I usually become great at it and don't want to change. With sports I kept changing because I was just trying them out but I never really liked any of them but when I found mountain biking i thought this could be fun to get into. I put all my focus into it and now Im a lot faster of a rider and really enjoy what I do. If I could pick one thing to specialize in then I could become really good at it. I could start out not so good but the become really good at it if you give me time and if I like the thing that I'm doing. If I become a specialist I can help my team out a lot with my specific expertise because I will understand a lot about what I am doing and how my contribution can help the team out as a whole even if it means that my teammates need to do a little more so that my section isn't the best and that everyone is equal to make the project as good as it can be.

4. Cite Your Sources

- Include at least 2 credible sources (articles, videos, or professional websites).

<https://medium.com/design-bootcamp/whats-your-ux-path-generalist-specialist-or-t-shaped-designer-2d0ea54a62d4>

<https://medium.com/@sebistincescu/specialist-vs-generalist-vs-t-shaped-how-to-future-proof-your-career-in-tech-65fae2b670c6>

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